Lesson 32 material: Adolescence: Discussion, Listening and Reading

English Stage 2 (B2) · Unit 3: Verb Tenses and Narration · The Human Lifespan

9.1: Discussion

From *High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students* by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0). This section: CC BY 4.0; authored, remixed or curated by Rebecca Al Haider via source content that was edited to the style and standards of the LibreTexts platform.
Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/High-Intermediate_Academic_Grammar_for_ESL_Students_(Al_Haider)/03%3A_Unit_3._Lifespan/09%3A_Adolescence/9.01%3A_Discussion
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Answer the following questions based on your experience and opinion. Read five classmates' posts and respond to two classmates pointing out any similarities or differences, asking clarifying questions, or giving your opinion on a point they make.

1. What was your adolescence like? What was your experience as a teenager?
2. What are some changes that teenagers experience?

9.2: Listening-Debunking Myths about Adolescence

From *High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students* by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0). This section: CC BY 4.0; authored, remixed or curated by Rebecca Al Haider via source content that was edited to the style and standards of the LibreTexts platform.
Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/High-Intermediate_Academic_Grammar_for_ESL_Students_(Al_Haider)/03%3A_Unit_3._Lifespan/09%3A_Adolescence/9.02%3A_Listening-Debunking_Myths_about_Adolescence
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

3.2.2.1. Exercise 1-Listening Comprehension

Watch the video Debunking Myths about Adolescence and build a basic understanding to prepare you for this chapter's reading. Answer the questions to check your comprehension.

Video: https://youtu.be/J0MtQgS6IZU

1. When is adolescence?

a. Around 10-16 years old
b. Around 13 years old
c. Around 16 years old
d. Around 10-20 years old

2. The second myth is related to brain development. Which statement below is true about adolescence?

a. Their brain and body make them do crazy things.
b. Their risk-taking is important in their development.
c. They cannot process emotions.
d. Rewards are hyperresponsive.

3. The third myth is related to parents. What is parents' role in adolescent's development of relationship and social networks?

a. Parents can let their adolescents interact with anyone and everyone.
b. Parents can limit the adolescent's interaction.
c. Parents can help them socialize in a safe and supportive way.
d. Parents can invite their adolescents to the parents' circle of friends.

"Debunking Myths about Adolescence" by Jenn Pfeifer is licensed by University of Oregon under CC BY.

Links on the original page

- Debunking Myths about Adolescence: https://youtu.be/JoMtQgS6IZU

9.3: Reading-What to Expect from Adolescence

From *High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students* by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0). This section: CC BY 4.0; authored, remixed or curated by Rebecca Al Haider via source content that was edited to the style and standards of the LibreTexts platform.
Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/High-Intermediate_Academic_Grammar_for_ESL_Students_(Al_Haider)/03%3A_Unit_3._Lifespan/09%3A_Adolescence/9.03%3A_Reading-What_to_Expect_from_Adolescence
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

3.2.3.1. Exercise 2-Reading Comprehension

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

1Adolescence is like a roller coaster — it can be tough, exciting, scary, and fun. Everyone has feelings, one way or the other, about the changes that come during this time in their life. Maybe you've heard talk of hormones and are terrified of them. Or maybe you've watched your older siblings grow up and can't wait to experience the same things that they did. Unfortunately, no matter **how you feel**, you cannot choose **when you will start to experience changes** or **what will happen**. The lack of control can make these changes scary or frustrating, but knowing what to expect might help you let go, sit back, and maybe even enjoy the ride.

2Adolescence is the time in your life when your body and mind start to mature in preparation for adulthood. It usually starts between ages 10 to 12 and lasts until you're an adult. Some kids may start experiencing changes earlier or later than their friends, and that's perfectly normal. There are a bunch of silly myths about puberty — like eating too much greasy food causes acne, or shaving hair causes it to grow back thicker and darker. Myths like these are completely bonkers! So if you are growing a lot of hair, or if you're developing differently than your peers, don't worry — nothing's wrong with you. We all have different biological clocks.

3The changes that happen during adolescence are not just physical. There are also intellectual, emotional, and social changes that happen during this time.

INTELLECTUAL

4When you enter adolescence, you start to think about things in a different way. You begin to think more often about abstract ideas, such as love and beauty, rather than thinking just about **what you can see and feel**. Your use of logic and problem-solving skills improves. And as you gain new responsibilities and understanding of the world around you, you usually start to think about the future more.

SOCIAL

5When you were younger, you probably mostly listened to the music your parents played. If I asked you when you were seven years old **what your favorite song was**, you might respond with a song from the 80s or 90s. But as you get older, you start to become interested in the songs your friends are listening to. Now, you might play "Renegade" on repeat while your mom looks at you like, What is so good about this "go go go go" nonsense? The point is, during adolescence, you start to become more independent, your friends may become more interesting to you than your family, and you start figuring out who you are outside of your parents in order to form your own identity.

PHYSICAL

6Your body will change in many ways during adolescence. This is **what people usually refer to** when talking about "puberty." Puberty can begin as early as age 8 and as late as 15, depending on the person. These changes do not happen all at once; in fact, one common change is a growth spurt, which can last for 2-3 years. You might experience a lot of growing pains at the beginning of adolescence, and your body might start to change into a shape you don't recognize. That might feel a little weird, but you are still the same old you. Take some time to get to know the new version of yourself.

7During puberty, you will start to grow armpit hair and possibly facial hair, too. You might notice that you sweat a lot more than before (and if you don't notice, try not to be too embarrassed if one day your parent gives you some deodorant). Some kids also experience acne, voice changes, and weight gain. These are just a few examples of **how much your body changes during this time period**. These changes happen at different times for different people, but they're completely normal. And if you're still worried, it's important to remember that puberty won't last forever.

EMOTIONAL

8The emotional changes that happen during adolescence might be the most challenging. The hormones in your body can cause mood swings that can make you shift from smiling to crying to wanting to scream — before your best friend can even tell you to chill. It might not feel chill, but it is pretty normal during adolescence to become easily irritated and feel aggressive or sad. You may quickly switch between emotions or even feel multiple emotions at the same time. **Why you feel these things** can seem like a mystery; there may not even be a reason besides the rise in hormones in your body.

9The good news is that it gets better and more manageable over time. Younger teens, or preteens, are more likely to experience stronger mood swings. When you get caught up in a wave of emotion, try taking a deep breath and calmly reflecting on the source of these feelings. If however you feel sad, hopeless, or angry most of the time, be sure to talk to an adult about it.

Image 27 "*Now and Then* " *by Svein Halvor Halvorsen is licensed under CC BY-NC-ND* .

10In fact, it's always good to talk about **what you're going through**. The changes you face during adolescence can be challenging. It can feel scary when so much is changing so quickly; you might feel like you don't recognize yourself and have no control over **what's happening**. But talking to others honestly can help you take control. It might feel a little weird or embarrassing to talk about, but we've all been there! If you're having mood swings or growing pains, the adults in your life will understand. Talking to your friends is another great option, since they are likely going through similar things as you are. The more people talk about these things, the more everyone will realize **how normal it is**. Just make sure that if you have any questions you get your information from reliable sources.

11This period of change is hard, but it's an important stage in anyone's life. Adolescence prepares the body and mind for the demands of adulthood. The intellectual and social changes will help you gain a sense of independence and plan for your future. The hormones that cause physical and emotional changes will prompt your body to begin shifting into its adult form and will prepare you for the physical and emotional demands of adult jobs and relationships. All of these changes will help guide you toward adulthood.

1. Which statement best expresses the main idea in the article?

a. It is impossible to understand the reason for the sudden changes in emotions during adolescence.

b. All individuals have the same experience and go through the same intellectual, emotional, social and physical changes in adolescence.

c. Even though all individuals experience the intellectual, emotional, social and physical changes of adolescence, everyone has a unique experience.

d. Adults are essential to really support teenagers through the intellectual, emotional, social and physical changes that they go through during the period of adolescence.

2. How does the author support her ideas about the adolescent experience?

a. Smith provides many different examples of the changes that all individuals will go through.

b. Smith speaks directly to adolescents to explain how they will all experience changes differently.

c. Smith uses scientific data to explain what is happening biologically as individuals go through adolescence.

d. Smith speaks to parents to explain how they need to be more patient and understanding with their children as they experience adolescence.

3. Who is the audience of this article, and why does the author speak to this audience directly?

a. The author speaks to teenagers to explain what's happening in their bodies.

b. The author speaks to teachers to understand how to understand their teenage students.

c. The author speaks to parents to explain what's happening in their teenage children's body.

d. The author speaks to scientists to help them understand what else to study about adolescence.

4. What is the relationship between the physical and emotional changes that adolescents experience?

a. The emotional changes cause the physical changes.

b. The physical changes cause the emotional changes.

c. The physical changes are minimal compared to the emotional changes.

d. The emotional changes are minimal compared to the physical changes.

"What to Expect from Adolescence" by Barrett Smith is licensed by CommonLit under CC BY-NC-SA 2.0

Links on the original page

- What to Expect from Adolescence: https://www.commonlit.org/en/texts/what-to-expect-from-adolescence
- CommonLit: https://www.commonlit.org/en

16.7: Chapter 7

From *High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students* by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0). This section: CC BY 4.0; authored, remixed or curated by Rebecca Al Haider via source content that was edited to the style and standards of the LibreTexts platform.
Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/High-Intermediate_Academic_Grammar_for_ESL_Students_(Al_Haider)/05%3A_Appendices/Appendix_B%3A_Audio_Transcripts/16.07%3A_Chapter_7
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

4.7.1. Listening Comprehension

00:02 We all know teenagers like to think of themselves as unique.

00:06 The first time I saw a teenager's brain on

00:08 the console at the scanner it was just,

00:10 like that's what makes you different from

00:11 any other human on the planet.

00:15 That's you.

00:17 My name is Jenn Pfeifer and

00:18 I'm a professor of psychology at the University of Oregon.

00:22 I study adolescent development.

00:24 It feels like pretty much everything changes in adolescence,

00:27 from your new biology to your social world.

00:30 I study how these changes are intertwined with each other

00:33 and how they affect your mental health, well-being, and risk behavior.

00:39 There are a lot of myths and misunderstandings

00:41 about adolescence that I'm trying to change.

00:44 One misunderstanding is about when adolescence happens

00:47 or who is an adolescent.

00:49 Most people probably imagine

00:51 a rowdy bunch of 16-year-old boys who skip class stuffed into a car,

00:57 and are speeding down the road to get lunch.

00:59 Or maybe a pimply 13-year-old

01:01 whose body is reshaping itself before their own eyes

01:05 in embarrassing and confusing ways.

01:08 But the truth is adolescence is a much longer and more complex period of life.

01:12 It has a biological beginning with puberty, which can start as early as nine or ten years of age.

01:18 And a social end with the assumption of adult roles

01:21 and responsibilities, typically sometime in your 20s.

01:24 I often say that means adolescence doesn't have a capital "A".

01:28 It's not just one or two big things that happen or a couple of problems

01:32 get solved, but a long series of changes with different timing and

01:36 patterns in your body, brain, behavior, and relationships.

01:42 Since teenagers can drive adults up the wall at times it's important to

01:46 reconsider how we interpret their behavior.

01:49 A really damaging myth about adolescence is that

01:52 these changes in their bodies and brains make them do crazy things.

01:57 We often hear the media say teens have an immature prefrontal cortex

02:01 or it's underdeveloped or even broken or missing.

02:06 On the other hand, they also say their systems for processing emotions and rewards

02:12 are hyperresponsive, in overdrive, left unchecked because

02:16 the prefrontal cortex isn't ready to take control yet.

02:22 There are two really important things to know about this myth.

02:26 One, it's just not that simple.

02:28 You can also use your prefrontal cortex to plan how to achieve any kind of goal

02:33 including ones adults might call risky.

02:36 But two, and this is maybe the surprising part, It's actually really

02:40 important for adolescents to take risks.

02:44 A risk is just a decision where the outcome is unknown

02:47 and trying things we don't know the answer to is how we learn.

02:53 Adolescence is this magical time where biology and your social environment

02:58 both work together to create opportunities to take risks.

03:02 So you learn more, by exploring and by trying out these unknowns.

03:07 Do I like playing soccer? Am I any good at it?

03:11 I like being on the team more than I thought I would.

03:13 Does that guy or girl like me?

03:16 Whoa dating someone is more stressful than I thought it would be.

03:20 It's a good time to try new things because as an adolescent you're in between.

03:25 You have more capabilities and more independence, but you've also got a safety-net in your family.

03:31 That highlights a third misconception, that parents don't really matter anymore in adolescence.

03:37 While it's true that peer and romantic relationships become increasingly important,

03:41 parents need to realize they still matter to adolescent well-being,

03:46 a lot.

03:48 The learning and risk-taking adolescence do is fueled by a need for social connection.

03:54 Although it can feel like it, parents aren't being replaced but

03:57 adolescents do need to develop their own relationships and networks of social support outside the family.

04:03 It's just part of growing up.

04:05 So maybe a better way to think about adolescence than as a crazy immature time,

04:10 is as a stage where the brain naturally becomes hungry for new experiences and social connections.

04:16 Teens seek them out and soak them up because that's their job.

04:20 It's how they grow and learn.

04:23 That means the teenage brain isn't flawed, it is perfectly designed

04:27 to help young people grow into the adults they will become.

04:31 If we as parents and as a society can help them do that in safe

04:35 supportive ways they can all reach their fullest potential.

“Debunking Myths about Adolescence” by Jenn Pfeifer is licensed by University of Oregon under CC BY.

Links on the original page

- Debunking Myths about Adolescence: https://youtu.be/JoMtQgS6IZU